Matt Lebrun

Engineering Leadership | Software Architecture | Team Development

Metro Manila, Philippines · matt@lebrun.org · mattlebrun.com · LinkedIn · GitHub

Profile

I lead engineering teams and continue to build software. I like getting to know the product, the people who use it, and the systems that support it. That understanding helps me set technical direction while giving engineers the context and room to make decisions and own their work.

My work has taken me from enterprise applications and startup data platforms to SaaS engineering, technical training, and community leadership. Across these roles, I have brought together hands-on problem solving, longer-term planning, and helping others develop their capabilities.

Areas of practice

Engineering leadership and mentoring · Product and technical direction · Software architecture · Python and backend systems · Cloud operations · Delivery and quality practices · Technical education

Professional experience

TotalRewards Software, Inc.

Director of Technology | February 2022–present

- Proposed a longer-term product direction that company leadership adopted, then worked with the team to identify the technical foundations and priorities needed to move toward it.
- Guide engineering planning and technical decisions, balancing product requests with the architecture, reliability, security, and maintenance work needed to support them.
- Give engineers responsibility for initiatives, encourage them to speak directly with stakeholders, and discuss their technical proposals with them so they can understand the problems and make informed decisions.
- Helped the team move toward more frequent releases, with engineers taking responsibility for deployment after testing. As delivery changed, encouraged the development of repeatable regression tests and automation.
- Support hiring, onboarding, and mentoring, and encourage the team to document decisions and their reasoning so others can continue the work.
- Continue to investigate technical problems and implement software, drawing on direct experience with the product and its operation.

Lead Developer | October 2017–February 2022

- Developed and supported an existing enterprise SaaS platform across application features, authentication and access controls, background processing, data workflows, and production operations.
- Worked with colleagues on developer tooling, testing, issue tracking, release preparation, and operational troubleshooting as the engineering team grew.

Save22, Inc. / BOB FTW PTE LTD

Software Developer → Senior Software Developer | April 2013–February 2017

- Built and maintained Python and Django systems that collected, cleaned, and normalized retail price and promotional data from multiple online sources.
- Worked with a small team on backend processing and architecture, and helped introduce container-based development and deployment workflows.
- Developed and maintained a hybrid mobile field application, working with the challenges of capturing and transferring information where connectivity was unreliable.
- Helped recruit and mentor engineering interns: prepared their working environments, helped them break down tasks, reviewed their work, and supported some as they guided newer interns.

Earlier engineering experience

Python Developer, Wealth Access International Holdings | March–October 2017

Software Developer, Search Opt Media | January 2012–April 2013

Software Development Analyst, Smart Communications | April 2011–August 2012

Software Engineer, Asurion / Techlog Center Philippines | July 2010–March 2011

Junior Developer → Senior Developer, Global Idealogy | December 2007–June 2010

Earlier work covered web applications and data collection, telecom data processing, enterprise software and Microsoft Dynamics AX, and systems administration.

Independent engineering

I maintain a personal homelab and build and integrate tools for learning, knowledge, and development. These projects let me follow a problem from the way someone uses a system through its design, implementation, and operation.

- Self-hosted knowledge workflow: designed and operated an integration between my wiki and Git repositories, allowing AI-assisted changes to be proposed and reviewed before they become part of the knowledge base.
- Transcription and knowledge tools: developed and integrated workflows for recording, transcription, processing, and revisiting information, combining application design, background work, external services, and practical testing.

Selected projects: github.com/cr8ivecodesmith

Teaching and community leadership

CodeHappy | Co-founder and Principal Trainer | 2018–present

Co-founded CodeHappy with Micaela Reyes. I design and facilitate technical training that connects Python and software development concepts to practical work, helping participants develop understanding they can apply independently.

PythonPH | Co-founder and volunteer leader | 2013–present

Helped establish PythonPH and have contributed to conferences, meetups, regional partnerships, and volunteer development. Worked with local organizers to bring PyCon Philippines beyond Metro Manila, sharing responsibility for programs and events. My current work includes volunteer training and engagement.

Education and recognition

Bachelor of Science in Information Technology | Don Bosco Technical College | 2003–2008

Python Software Foundation Fellow | 2019

Python Software Foundation Community Service Award | 2025 | Jointly awarded with Micaela Reyes